

SafeSmart



Alexandra Palermo & [REDACTED]

Project Description + Live Demonstration

- SafeSmart is an app to help prevent elderly people from being victims of internet-based financial scams. Many elderly people do not understand the technology that they use as part of their daily lives, which puts them at significant risk of harm. Our app is designed to allow them to maintain their freedom and independence without compromising their safety.
- Link to Figma Prototype: [Milestone 3 \(Copy\)](#)



Milestone One

User Research / Problem Formation and Ideation Phases

- Problem space: safety for elders online
- Key Stakeholders : elderly people & their relatives, law enforcement
- Solution: security app that watches for scams



ideas:

- child lock for boomers
- not much UI because it runs in the background mostly
- more UI for the trusted contact
 - either they also have the app + get notifications for sus activity + have pages they can check
 - or they don't have it + get like a weekly report + notif in email/text
- older client has it running in the background
- ability to check for data for the more tech savvy boomers



pop-up to warn of sus activity/behavior



completely blocking an action

trusted contact version:

- different info depending on privacy selection
- could give exact suspicious behavior or just say that it happened

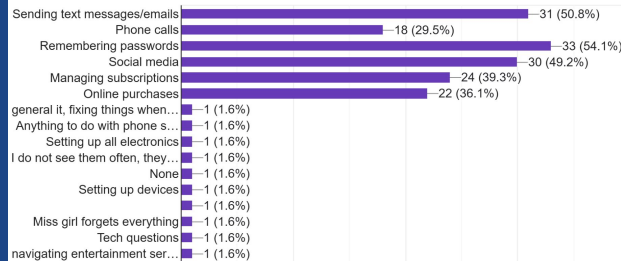
Milestone Two

User Research / Problem Formation and Ideation Phases

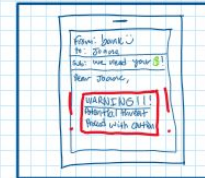
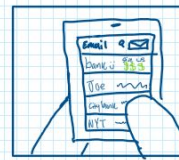
- User research method: survey
- Research findings solidified our app idea and which features would be added to the prototype
- Decided the app would be accessible by the elderly and their relatives

What specifically do you help your elderly relatives with?

61 responses



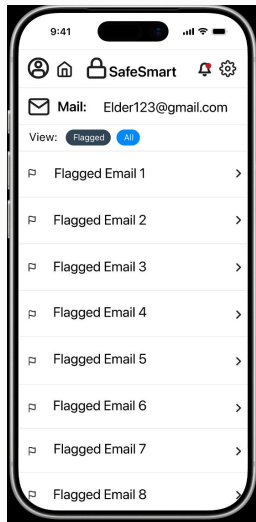
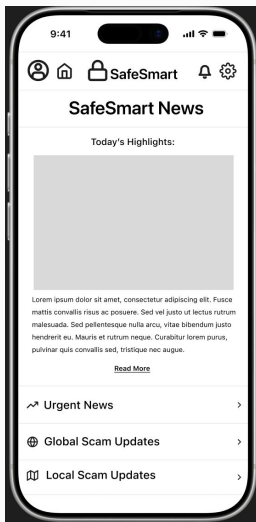
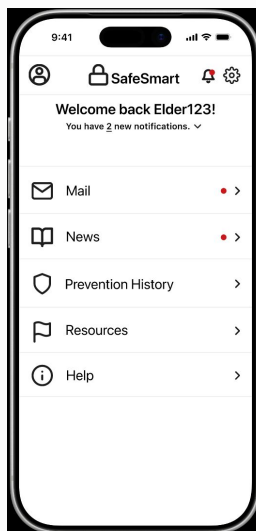
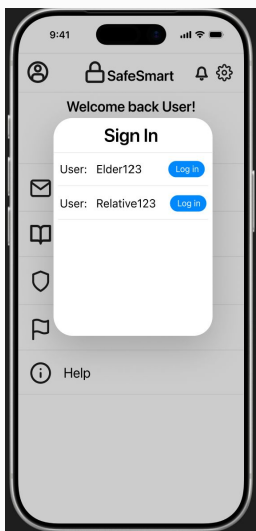
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Milestone Three

Initial Prototype + First Round Usability Testing Results

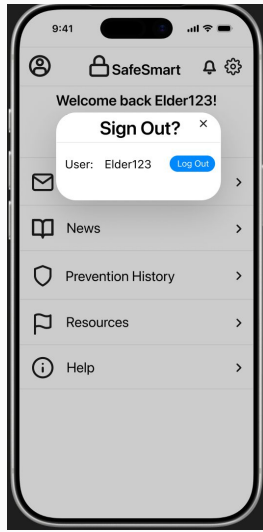
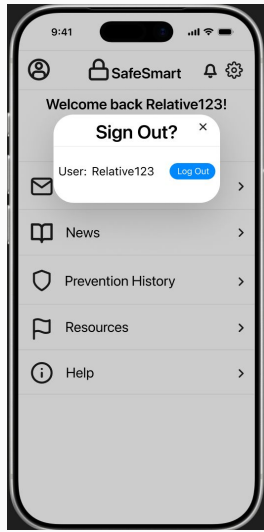
- Our goal was to create a user-friendly interface, for relatives and elders alike
- We used our user research to help shape the design of our prototype
- Initial prototype contained three tasks
- 3 participants in usability testing
- We asked all participants 3 questions after testing so we could improve our prototype





Final vs Initial

- Minimal design changes
- Two new tasks/usability tests
- Added a logout button based on specific feedback
- Added a new scenario that starts outside of the app



Strengths + Challenges

Strengths/Highlights:

- **User-centered design**
 - Based on survey feedback
 - Focused on wanted features
- **Simple + accessible UI**
 - Easy for elderly users + relatives alike
 - Clear and readable
- **Relevant core idea**
 - Provides a needed solution
 - Useful alert system
 - Scam protection that allows for independence
- **Familiar and meaningful features**
 - News section designed like a newspaper
 - Prioritizes older forms of communication (emailing)
- **Thoughtful design trade-offs**
 - Removed unnecessary features
 - Prioritized simplicity

Strengths + Challenges

Challenges:

- **Target audience mismatch**
 - Did user-testing with college students
 - No testing with ideal users (elderly + relatives)
- **User roles are too similar**
 - Little to no difference between accounts
 - Limited functionality for relatives
- **Incomplete / Inconsistent features**
 - Some actions were missing in certain screens
 - Alert system wasn't fully laid out
- **Feature confusion**
 - Some tabs were unclear (news)
 - User-testers weren't sure why some features were implemented
- **UI/Navigation issues**
 - Some icons not intuitive
- **Prototype limitations**
 - Figma couldn't fully simulate app behavior
 - Navigation/Flow slightly restricted
 - Hard to map actions so everything clickable led to the right place

Future Work

- Further explore how SafeSmart sends alerts while not using the app
- Add more differences between the elderly and relative accounts
- Improve app design

